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BOARD DECISION | 24. 9. 2025

Statement of the Bank Board for the press conference following the monetary policy meeting

Decision

At its meeting today, the Bank Board kept interest rates unchanged. The two-week repo rate thus remains at 3.5%. All seven members voted in favour of this decision.

According to the Monetary Department's updated forecast, inflation will be slightly above 2% for the rest of this year. In particular, core inflation will remain elevated. The ongoing inflation pressures from the domestic economy currently preclude a further decrease in interest rates.

Inflation has been close to the 2% target since January 2024. However, tight monetary policy is still needed. The quantity of money in the economy is rising and credit growth is gradually increasing. The labour market remains tight and wages are rising apace. At the same time, households' demand continues to grow. Services inflation remains elevated. Rising property prices are also a risk to inflation.

Today's decision aims to stabilise headline inflation close to the 2% inflation target in the long run. This requires growth in the quantity of money in the economy not to accelerate excessively and credit growth to remain moderate. By ensuring this, monetary policy will help keep inflation low.

At its meetings ahead, the Bank Board will base its decisions on an assessment of newly available data and their implications for the inflation outlook. Its considerations about the interest rate settings will depend mainly on an evaluation of the persistence of the low-inflation environment, koruna exchange rate developments, the effect of fiscal policy on the economy, an analysis of the tightness in the labour market, and changes in domestic and external demand. The Bank Board will also monitor the actions of key foreign central banks, geopolitical events and developments in trade relations between countries. It will also assess the transmission of previous interest rate cuts to lending activity, asset prices – above all property prices – and subsequently real economic activity and prices.

The Bank Board confirms its determination to continue its monetary policy in order to maintain inflation near the 2% target in the long term. At present, this still requires relatively tight monetary policy.

Economic developments

The latest data confirm an economic recovery based primarily on growth in domestic demand. GDP rose by 2.6% and household consumption by 3.4% year on year in 2025 Q2. Rapid nominal wage growth, which reached 7.8% year on year in the second quarter, is contributing to household spending.

In line with our expectations, headline inflation fell from 2.9% in June to 2.5% in August. While headline inflation is declining, core inflation remains just below 3%, standing at 2.8% in August. Services inflation and the contribution of property prices to inflation remain particularly elevated. The Monetary Department expects inflation to stay in the upper half of the CNB's tolerance band for the rest of the year.

Risks and uncertainties

The Bank Board assessed the risks and uncertainties of the outlook for the fulfilment of the inflation target as inflationary overall. As regards domestic inflationary risks, the risk of inertia in services inflation, including imputed rent, and in food inflation persists. A potential acceleration of money creation in the economy stemming from a further strengthening of lending activity, especially on the property market, is also an inflationary risk. Potential additional growth in total public sector spending would lead to a risk of fiscal policy having an even greater inflationary effect. Continued rapid wage growth related to persistent tightness in the labour market is an additional inflationary risk. By contrast, inflation could be dampened by a stronger koruna exchange rate. The launch of the EU Emissions Trading System 2 (ETS 2) is a risk to inflation in 2027 and the subsequent years. Increasing barriers to international trade are a downside risk to global economic activity. The risk of continued weak German economic output is partly offset by the planned fiscal stimulus of the new German government. The development of the wars in Ukraine and the Middle East still represents an uncertainty. Rising general government debt in some developed countries and increasing sensitivity of financial markets to sovereign risk are becoming a major source of uncertainty.

Statutory mandate

The Bank Board assures the public that the CNB's actions will be sufficient to maintain price stability in accordance with its statutory mandate. In addition, the Bank Board is ready to react appropriately to any materialisation of the risks of the outlook for the fulfilment of the inflation target.

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